

Friday, 2 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 20° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 19° 12°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 19° 13°	GLASGOW Rain 17° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Thousands of criminals are starting to leave prison early across England and Wales, under a new government scheme.

Around 4,500 inmates are expected to be released by June 2027. The move is designed to ease overcrowding in prisons.

CRIME · UK
- 2

A UK-Iranian dual national has been arrested in London in connection with Sunday's incident near RAF Fairford.

The 27-year-old man was arrested in Westminster, marking the sixth arrest over the incident. Police are continuing their investigations.

SECURITY · UK
- 3

The UK is reportedly in talks with EU partners about releasing strategic fuel reserves, should they be needed.

This follows a threat from US President Donald Trump to ban diesel exports, aiming to ease prices in America. The situation is being closely monitored.

ENERGY · UK
- 4

Police investigating the discovery of a baby's body in Bangor, Wales, say it was a girl and may have been in the water for weeks.

The body was found near Siliwen Road, and a post-mortem examination has confirmed the gender. Detectives are appealing for information.

CRIME · UK
- 5

The Bank of England's boss, Andrew Bailey, has warned that the boom in Artificial Intelligence could trigger market shocks.

He says the central bank is watching the huge amounts of money being invested in AI "very carefully." It's a rapidly evolving sector.

ECONOMY · UK

What's coming up

1 **The star-studded line-up for the new series of Celebrity Traitors has been revealed, with filming already underway!**

Maya Jama, Michael Sheen, and Bella Ramsey are among the famous faces taking part this year. We can't wait to see who's a Traitor and who's Faithful.

ON AIR – Who do you think will be the best Traitor this year?

TV · COMING UP

2 **The stars of the upcoming 'Practical Magic' reboot say people are longing for simpler times.**

Maisie Williams and Joey King feature in the sequel to the 1998 fantasy rom-com. It's set to bring a touch of magic back to our screens.

ON AIR – What's your favourite magical movie or TV show?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **Good news if you're planning ahead for Glastonbury 2027 – coach tickets have already sold out!**

They were snapped up in under 30 minutes, showing just how popular the festival remains. Keep an eye out for general sale tickets.

ON AIR – Have you ever managed to get Glastonbury tickets, and was it worth the effort?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **The British Museum is set to offer a special audio-described tour of the Bayeux Tapestry.**

It's designed for people with impaired vision, allowing more visitors to experience the historic artwork. A wonderful initiative.

ON AIR – What historical artefact would you love to see or learn more about?

CULTURE · COMING UP

5 **A former Dallas Cowboys Cheerleader is impressing audiences on Broadway, after a celebrity casting row.**

She's overcome criticism of 'stunt casting' for her debut in 'Chicago'. It just goes to show talent shines through.

ON AIR – Do you think celebrities should always have to 'earn their stripes' in theatre?

THEATRE · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 Downing Street has weighed in on the Manchester City verdict, insisting the club is not "above the rules."**
 This follows a backlash to remarks by Andy Burnham. The Prime Minister added he'd be "really concerned" if the club's owners sold up.
ON AIR – What do you think the long-term impact of this verdict will be on Manchester City?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 England have avoided defending champions Australia and world number one India in the 2027 Cricket World Cup draw.**
 It's a potentially favourable draw for England in the group stage. The tournament promises to be an exciting one.
ON AIR – Are you optimistic about England's chances in the 2027 Cricket World Cup?
 CRICKET · UK
- 3 Could 2026 finally be the year for Warrington Wolves to win their first Super League Grand Final?**
 They're often the 'nearly' side, but this Saturday they have another shot at glory. All eyes will be on Old Trafford.
ON AIR – Do you think Warrington Wolves can finally get over the line and win the Grand Final this weekend?
 RUGBY · UK
- 4 Formula 1 driver George Russell says his "confidence is back and growing" as he looks to end a difficult season on a high.**
 He's aiming to chase down team-mate Kimi Antonelli's championship lead. It's great to hear he's feeling more positive.
ON AIR – Which British F1 driver are you rooting for this season?
 F1 · UK
- 5 The Women's Tennis Association has confirmed that all its combined 1000 events will award equal prize money from 2027.**
 This is being hailed as a "major milestone" for the sport. It's a significant step towards greater equality.
ON AIR – How important is it to you that prize money is equal across men's and women's sports?
 TENNIS · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful new trend sees people creating 'miniature libraries' for garden gnomes in their back gardens.**
These tiny book nooks, filled with acorn-sized scrolls and leaf-bound volumes, are bringing a whimsical touch to outdoor spaces and sparking joy for many. It's a charming way to encourage a bit of garden magic!
- 2 Research suggests that 'the satisfying crinkle of a fresh packet of biscuits' can trigger a unique wave of anticipation and happiness.**
It seems that particular sound, combined with the aroma, signals an upcoming moment of comfort and indulgence, proving that small sensory experiences can have a big impact on our mood.
- 3 A quiet movement is growing for 'collecting vintage postcards' from seaside towns and forgotten holiday spots.**
People are finding joy in the faded images and handwritten messages from decades past, offering a nostalgic glimpse into Britain's holiday history and a sweet connection to the past.
- 4 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'watching a slow train journey' on a rainy afternoon.**
The rhythmic motion and changing scenery, without the need for active engagement, are proving to be a surprisingly effective way to unwind and de-stress in our busy lives.
- 5 A charming local initiative encourages people to 'leave friendly notes' on park benches for others to discover.**
These small, uplifting messages, from a simple 'Have a lovely day!' to a short poem, are creating unexpected moments of connection and spreading a little bit of cheer in communities.
- 6 New findings suggest that 'the gentle sound of pages turning' in a quiet library can be remarkably soothing.**
It seems the subtle rustle and the peaceful atmosphere contribute to a sense of calm and focus, reminding us of the simple pleasures found in quiet contemplation.
- 7 The delightful hobby of 'identifying cloud shapes' is gaining popularity among those seeking a moment of mindful relaxation.**
Taking a few moments to look up and spot familiar figures or patterns in the clouds is proving to be a simple yet effective way to reconnect with nature and spark a bit of imagination.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new film on the telly, especially if it's one you've been looking forward to. What is it?

ANSWER: ADJUSTING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA TO 'JUST THE RIGHT' LEVEL OF PLUMPNESS.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOX A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR THE 'CRUNCH POTENTIAL' OF THE CONTENTS.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular smell' just instantly transports you back to a specific memory or feeling, perhaps from your childhood or a happy holiday?

What's that one smell for you, whether it's freshly cut grass, baking bread, or even a particular type of soap, that immediately takes you back to a lovely moment in time?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your life without because it's just so useful or brings you a little bit of joy, don't we?

What's that one unexpected everyday item in your home – perhaps a specific mug, a trusty old colander, or even a favourite tea towel – that you'd truly miss if it suddenly vanished?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies use their antennae to smell flowers, but they taste with their feet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest chameleon, the *Brookesia micra*, is so tiny it can sit comfortably on the tip of a matchstick.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death in the city by destroying many of the rat-infested buildings.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The average person spends about six months of their life waiting for traffic lights to change.
- Norway once knighted a penguin named Brigadier Sir Nils Olav III, who is the mascot of the Norwegian King's Guard.
- Chocolatiers, who make chocolate, are sometimes called 'chocolate architects' for their precise craft.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- The world's first ever webcam was created in 1991 to monitor a coffee pot at the University of Cambridge.

On this day

Day 275 of the year, 90 days left in 2026. Today Batik Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Blessed Antoine Chevrier; Christian feast day: Denha I of Tikrit (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Jan Beyzym. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Badly Drawn Boy, English musician
- 1976 — Mark Chilton, English cricketer
- 1967 — Gillian Welch, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1956 — Freddie Jackson, American soul singer
- 1948 — Avery Brooks, American actor
- 1952 — Robin Riker, American actress
- 1973 — Efen Ramirez, American actor
- 1949 — Richard Hell, American singer-songwriter and bass player

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — Five Amish girls are murdered in a shooting at a school in Pennsylvania, United States.
- 1970 — An aircraft carrying the Wichita State University football team, administrators, and supporters crashes in Colorado, killing 31 people.
- 1971 — British European Airways Flight 706 crashes near Aarsele, Belgium, killing 63.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1980 — Michael Myers becomes the first member of either chamber of Congress to be expelled since the Civil War.
- 2007 — President Roh Moo-hyun of South Korea goes to North Korea for an Inter-Korean summit with North Korean leader Kim Jong-il.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1944 — World War II: German troops end the Warsaw Uprising.
- 1971 — British European Airways Flight 706 crashes near Aarsele, Belgium, killing 63.

- 2002 — The Beltway sniper attacks begin in Washington, D.C., extending over three weeks and killing 10 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 276 of the year, 89 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Adalgott; Christian feast day: Ambrósio Francisco Ferro; Christian feast day: Blessed Szilárd Bogdánffy. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — G. Love, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and harmonica player
- 1970 — Jimmy Ray, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1979 — Josh Klinghoffer, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1995 — Ayo Edebiri, American actress
- 1975 — India Arie, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1934 — Benjamin Boretz, American composer and theorist
- 1981 — Matt Sparrow, English footballer
- 1964 — Clive Owen, English actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2024 — Bengali, Assamese, Marathi, Pali and Prakrit are accorded the Classical language status by the Government of India
- 1949 — WERD, the first black-owned radio station in the United States, opens in Atlanta.
- 2023 — Wab Kinew is elected to be the first First Nations Premier of a Canadian province in the 2023 Manitoba general election

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1946 — An American Overseas Airlines Douglas DC-4 crashes near Ernest Harmon Air Force Base in Stephenville, Newfoundland and Labrador, Canada, killing 39.
- 2024 — Bengali, Assamese, Marathi, Pali and Prakrit are accorded the Classical language status by the Government of India

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 **Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller**

FRI 23 **Frankenstein (del Toro)**

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar